

NOVAHR

HR and Payroll, Built for South African Business

How-To Guides

Step-by-step task reference

hello@novahr.co.za | novahr-five.vercel.app

NovaHR How-To Guides

Audience: HR Administrators (unless noted). Each guide is written to stand alone in the knowledge base. **Screenshots:** Placeholders marked [Screenshot: ●] to be captured from the live app.

1. Add an Employee

Add employee
Capture the details needed to add a new team member and kick off their onboarding checklist.

1 Personal details
Basic and contact information

2 Role & employment
Position, department and reporting

3 Compensation
Salary, allowances and banking

4 Review & confirm
Check details before creating

Basic information

First name
e.g. Thandiwe

Last name
e.g. Nkosi

Preferred name (optional)
e.g. Thandi

ID number
e.g. 9001015009087

Email address
e.g. john.smith@company.co.za

Phone number
e.g. 076 123 4567

Tax number (optional)
e.g. 9123456789

Residential address
e.g. 12 Long Street, Cape Town, 8001

Emergency contact

Full name
e.g. Nomsa Nkosi

Relationship
e.g. Spouse

Phone number
e.g. 082 345 6789

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Add employee: complete all required fields

1. Go to **Employees** and click **Add Employee**.
2. **Personal:** full names, SA ID or passport number, date of birth, contact details. The date of birth must be exact: it determines tax rebates.
3. **Employment:** position, department, start date, working pattern (5 or 6 day week).
4. **Pay:** basic salary, allowances (housing, travel with its inclusion rate), pension percentage, medical aid contribution and number of dependants.
5. **Banking:** bank, branch code, account number (verify against a bank letter).

6. **Leave:** opening balances if the employee joined before your NovaHR cut-over.
7. **Save.** The employee appears in the register and is included in the next payroll run.

[Screenshot: Add Employee form]

2. Process Payroll

The screenshot shows the NovaHR Payroll dashboard. The left sidebar contains navigation links: Dashboard, Employees, Payroll (selected), Compliance, Leave, Deductions, Reports, Tenants, Billing, and Settings. The main content area is titled 'Payroll' and includes a sub-header 'Review pay runs, track totals and publish payslips to your team.' Below this, there's a section for 'August 2026 payroll is ready to pay' with a 'Submit payroll to Netcash' button. A summary card shows: Next pay date 25 Sept 2026 (15 employees), Projected gross R1.3M (Current roster, per month), Projected net R 817.9K (After tax and deductions), and Year to date R5.7M (8 completed runs). Below this is a 'Netcash account' section with a 'Load' button. The 'September 2026 payroll' section is marked 'Scheduled' and shows an upcoming run for the current pay period with details: Pay date 25 September 2026, Eligible employees 16, and Projected gross R1,289,166.68, with a 'Start payroll run' button. At the bottom, a 'Payroll history' table shows a completed run for August 2026.

Period	Pay date	Status	Employees	Gross	Net
August 2026	25 Aug 2026	Completed	15	R 1,347,500.01	R 846,877.98

Starting a payroll run

1. Go to **Payroll** and click **New Run**; select the pay period.
2. NovaHR calculates every active employee: gross, PAYE, UIF, deductions, employer costs.
3. Add once-off items for the period: overtime hours, bonuses, unpaid leave days.
4. Review the run summary, then open individual payslips for anything unusual (new starters, terminations, changed salaries).
5. Click **Approve** when satisfied. Approval is recorded in the audit log.
6. Click **Publish** to release payslips to employee self-service and email.
7. Export the run report for your records and EMP201 figures.

Tip: never publish an unreviewed run; employees see published payslips immediately.

[Screenshot: Payroll run review]

3. Approve Leave

NovaHR Leave

Review requests, track balances and manage leave policies.

[+ Request leave](#)

Pending requests: 2 (Awaiting review)

On leave today: 2 (Out of 17 employees)

Approved this period: 4 (34 days total)

Declined this period: 2 (Requests rejected)

Requests | Calendar | Balances | Policies | Public holidays

All statuses | All types

Employee	Type	Dates	Days	Reason	Doc	Status	Actions
Aisha Patel (Engineering)	Annual leave	03 Jul 2026 to 31 Jul 2026	21	awdawdawdw		Approved	Lerato Dlamini
Aisha Patel (Engineering)	Sick leave	10 Jun 2026 to 11 Jun 2026	2	Flu, doctor's note attached.		Approved	Thabo Nkosi
Johan Pretorius (Engineering)	Family responsibility leave	15 Jun 2026 to 15 Jun 2026	1	School orientation day for my ...		Rejected	Lerato Dlamini
Buhle Khumalo (Sales)	Annual leave	22 Jun 2026 to 26 Jun 2026	5	Family event in Durban, flights ...		Pending	✓ ✕
Tumi Sithole (Finance)	Unpaid leave	01 Jul 2026 to 03 Jul 2026	3	Extended family visiting from o...		Pending	✓ ✕
Craig Adams (Sales)	Annual leave	10 Jul 2026 to 17 Jul 2026	6	Annual family holiday to the Ga...		Approved	Lerato Dlamini
Naledi Mahlangu (Engineering)	Annual leave	09 Jun 2026 to 13 Jun 2026	5	Family vacation to Mauritius, b...		Approved	Lerato Dlamini
Werner Botha (Finance)	Annual leave	20 May 2026 to 22 May 2026	3	Short break before month end.		Rejected	Lerato Dlamini

LD Lerato Dlamini HR Administrator

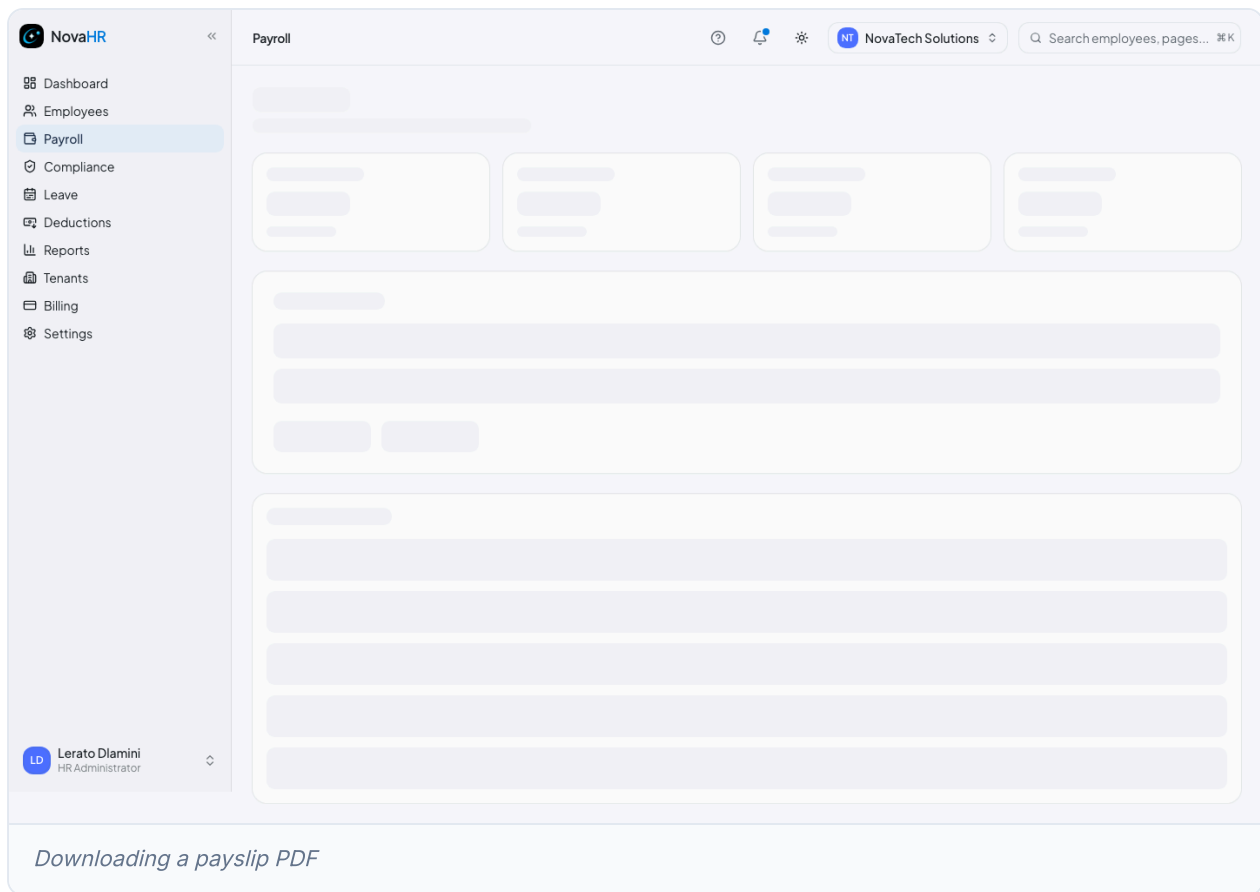
Approving a leave request

Roles: Manager or HR Admin.

1. Open **Leave**. Pending requests appear with dates, type, and remaining balance.
2. Click a request to see the detail: balance after approval, overlapping team leave, attached documents (e.g. medical certificate).
3. Click **Approve** or **Reject** (rejection asks for a reason, sent to the employee).
4. Approved leave updates the balance and the team calendar automatically, and paid/unpaid treatment flows to payroll.

[Screenshot: Leave approvals queue]

4. Generate Payslips

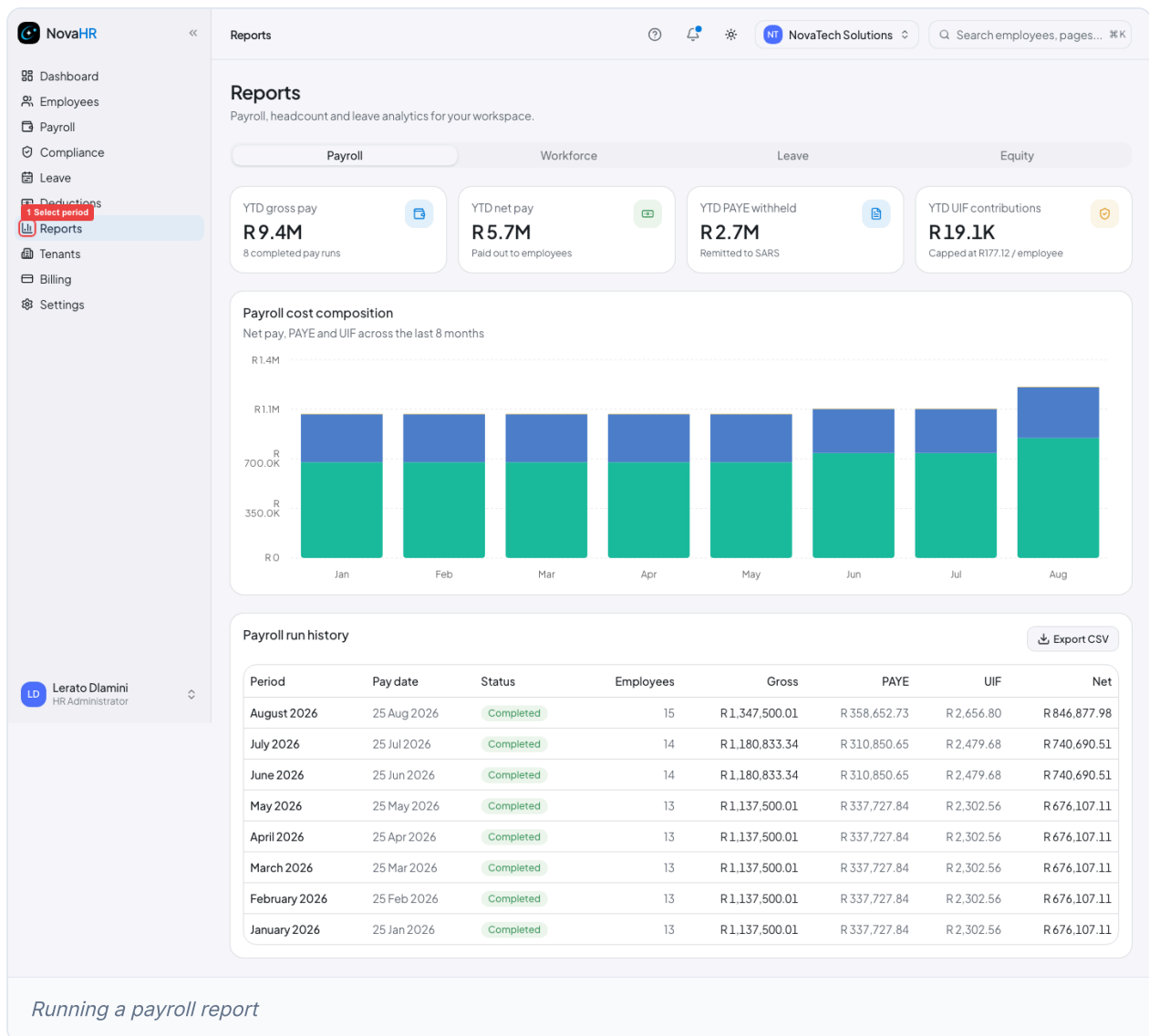


Payslips are generated automatically in each payroll run. To retrieve them:

1. **Bulk:** Payroll, open a run, **Download payslips** for all employees in the run.
2. **Single:** Employees, select the employee, **Payslips** tab, download the period's PDF.
3. **Employee self-service:** employees download their own payslips from their dashboard.
4. Payslips include the BCEA section 33 required particulars and are emailed on publication if enabled.

[Screenshot: Payslip PDF]

5. Export Reports



1. Go to **Reports**.
2. Choose a report: payroll run summary, employee costs, leave balances, headcount, deductions.
3. Set the period and any filters (department, employee).
4. Click **Export** (CSV for spreadsheets, PDF for filing).
5. Archive monthly payroll exports: SARS requires 5 years of payroll records.

[Screenshot: Reports page]

6. Add a Department

1. Go to **Departments** and click **Add Department**.
2. Name it and (optionally) assign a manager, who then sees the department's leave requests.

3. Save. Departments are available in employee profiles, filters, and reports.

7. Add a Job Title (Position)

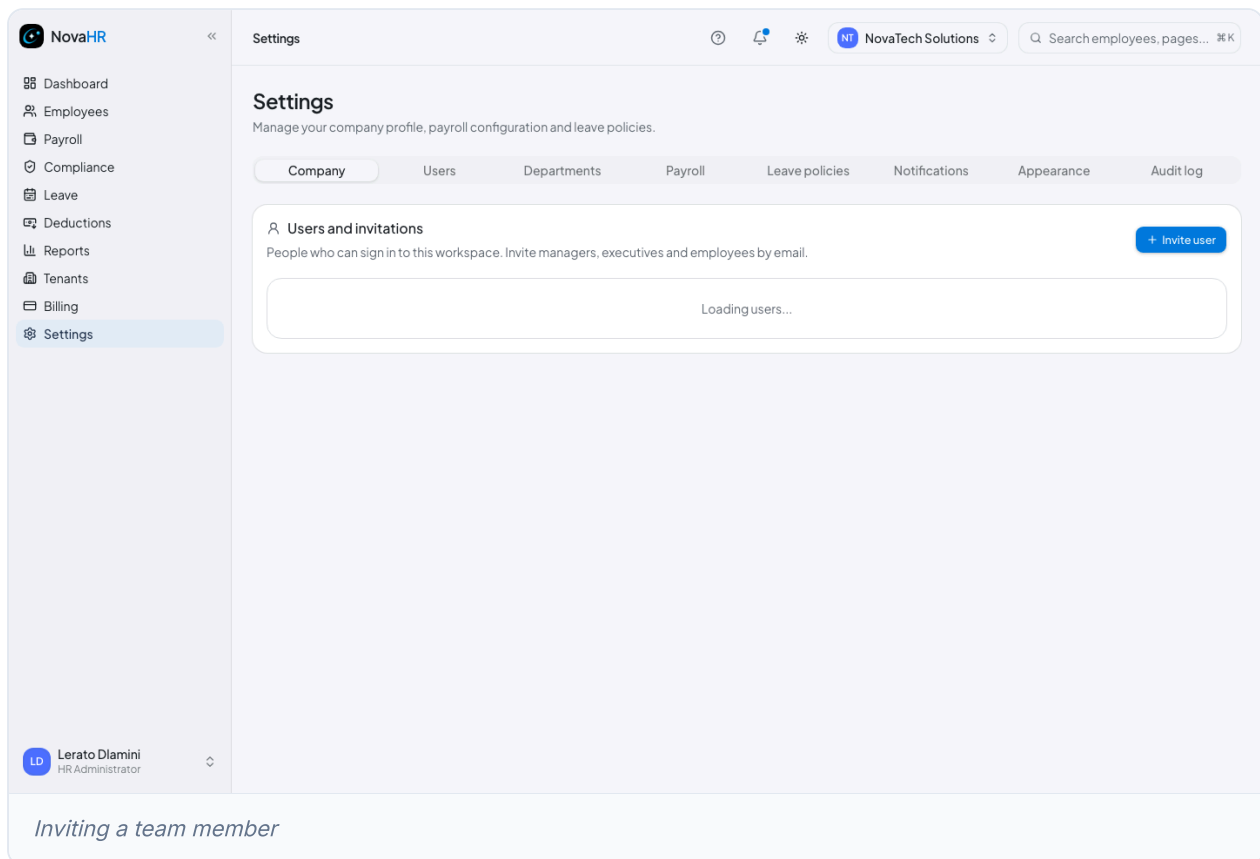
1. Go to **Positions** and click **Add Position**.
2. Enter the title, link a department, and save.
3. Assign it on the employee profile. Position history is retained for reporting.

8. Back Up (Export) Your Data

NovaHR runs automated daily backups of the platform. For your own statutory records:

1. Monthly: export the payroll run report after each run (Reports);
2. Quarterly: export the employee register and leave balances (CSV);
3. Store exports in your own document system; you are responsible for statutory retention (SARS 5 years, BCEA 3 years);
4. Before cancelling a subscription, export everything during the 30-day export window.

9. Invite Users



1. Go to **Settings, Users** and click **Invite**.
2. Enter the person's email and select the role: Employee, Manager, HR Admin, or Executive.
3. The invitee receives an email link, sets their own password, and lands in their role's view.
4. Link the user account to the matching employee record so self-service shows the right payslips.
5. Deactivate users on termination: **Settings, Users, Deactivate** (this preserves history but blocks login).

Never share one login between people: approvals and payroll actions are attributed to the logged-in user in the audit log.

10. Reset a Password

Your own: click **Forgot password** on the login page; a single-use reset link is emailed to you (valid for a limited time).

For another user (HR Admin): Settings, Users, select the user, **Send password reset**. NovaHR staff and HR Admins can trigger a reset email but can never view or set a password.

Locked out entirely (lost access to the email account): contact hello@novahr.co.za from another verified company address; we will verify identity with your account owner before acting.